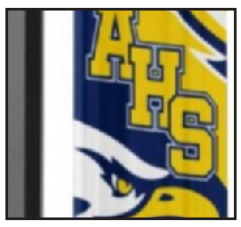
ANDOVER VIEW

Senior Class Gift / 4



Farewell Quotes / 4

Volume 6, Issue 6 www.andoverview.net June 9, 2025

STAFF PHOTO / **Anya Gorovits**

Seniors pose before their graduation ceremony. Pictured from left to right: Tristan Berty, Wes Aja, Owen Andrade, Emily Tsai, Brandon Nguyen, Glafira Kiyko, Amelia Barron, and Eli Peck.

Class of 2025 Graduation

Ceremony Celebrates Collective Excellence

By Areeta Faiz & Ella Hu || STAFF WRITERS

Anticipation settled through a full audience as valedictorian John Weng and salutatorian Sahil Khosla carefully led the graduation committee to the stage. With their heads held high, the duo gripped their ceremonial maces firmly in hand, a quiet testament to their academic achievements. Walking down the aisle again, this time accompanied by the band's triumphant theme, they led the Class of 2025 with pride. Collectively, the soon-to-be graduates took their seats one last time next to the teammates, acquaintances, and friends they've known since childhood.

The Class of 2025 graduated on June 2, 2025, at the Tsongas Center in Lowell. The ceremony was filled with appreciation for the community and the rebuilding of the AHS spirit throughout their high school careers.

When asked about how they felt before graduating, seniors responded that under their smiles, they were busy worrying about the possibilities of tripping on stage or their ornately decorated caps falling off.

Prior to the ceremony, while recounting their experiences, nearly all spoke of the most powerful part of their journey: their friends.

"[During] lunches I had with my friends…we just ate and talked, and we didn't really think about the end of high school," said senior Judy Elkotory wistfully. "But now it's here."

Senior Sophia Ciaccio recalled, "[I met] my closest friends in high school… and I've really grown as a person." This sentiment was echoed by nearly the entire senior class.

Graduation speeches praised excellence in all that the seniors accomplished. Every speaker agreed that the Class of 2025 poured their hearts into everything they did, academically, artistically, and athletically, through service, commitment, and passion.

Senior class essayist Will Dever highlighted the unique trials and tribulations that made this year's group unlike any before, including having to enter high school during the COVID-19 pandemic. He also noted that the 2007 birth spike made this class exceptionally competitive.

"I am confident that everyone sitting in front of me will be prepared for whatever the world has to throw at them," he said. "Unpredictability is something that we have learned to live with."

Superintendent Magda Parvey acknowledged the seniors' ability to come together to accomplish remarkable feats, as well as their "leadership, not just as individuals, but collectively, leading by example, inside and outside of school." Parvey, who came on board

GRADUATION / **page 4**

Student to Direct Film This Summer

By Abby Chachus || STAFF WRITER

AHS Film Club president Scott Strellis is working on directing his first original film, *Horizon*.

For Strellis, filmmaking has always been more than a hobby. "[Film Club has] been doing a lot of short films, preparing for this throughout the years," he explained. Now, as director of his first film, he is putting all those lessons into practice. "Directing is mainly about being as creative as possible, communicating well with others, and finding a good workflow," Strellis said.

Horizon tells the heartfelt story of a teenager grappling with loss and responsibility. "It's a coming-of-age sailing film," Strellis said. "The main character tries to find out what his identity is through sailing, because he's had some hardship with loved ones passing away, and he has to take a lot of responsibility for himself, in terms of growing up."

While *Horizon* is Strellis's first time directing a project, it's not his first experience on a film set. Two years ago, he helped with little things in the creation of *Bonsai*, another student film. That experience, along with the support of the AHS community, has been very valuable in helping him learn the skills he needs to create his own movie. "The resources at the high school let me show all my creative ideas and really help with the workflow," said Strellis.

Collaboration is important to the creation of *Horizon*. Strellis is working with senior Ben Murphitt and sophomore Rohit Perugupalli to write the script and put it all together.

"Since I am not as experienced with playwriting, it has been an enlightening and educational experience," said Perugupalli. He also explained that overall, the experience has been pretty positive.

Faculty advisor Daniel Brennan, who previously guided the *Bonsai* project, is offering mentorship, and former student Nate Allen has provided advice and encouragement as well.

"There's a QR code on the forms [hanging around school]. We did the major casting already, but we'll always have open parts for extras and those who just want to stop by for cameos," Strellis said.

Volunteering's Flip Side: Helping Others Helps Us Too

By Clara Strong || STAFF WRITER

The sun is shining and the air is fresh with possibility. Rows of green stretch out in front of you, punctuated by dots of yellow and red vegetables and volunteers waving hoses over tiny carrots. Though the air is hot, the wind is refreshing, and it feels good to get off TikTok for a while. Your friend walks by you, carrying a box of lettuce.

"We harvested enough today to feed 330 people!" they yell, and you grin back at them, knowing that children will go to bed with full stomachs because of your hard work. Your hands are dirty from pushing beans into the ground, but you know that in a few months, you'll be able to come back and see the fruits—and vegetables—of your labor.

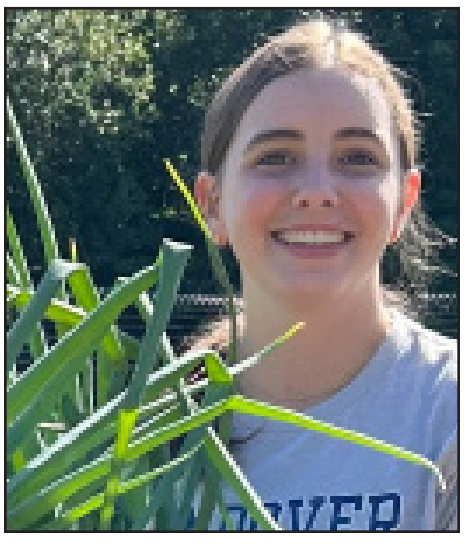
Everyone knows volunteering is great for the cause and the community, but it can also be a huge benefit to the volunteer. It can give people a purpose and a community with shared interests. Plus, when volunteering involves manual labor outdoors, that exercise and fresh air is great for well-being. According to a study of teens and kids by Kevin Lanza at the University of Texas Health in Houston, volunteering is associated with a lower rate of anxiety and higher well-being.

One reason why volunteering is such a benefit to mental health is that it gives the volunteer a community of people with shared interests. According to Betsey Desfosse, a health teacher at Andover High School, "Kids will say they don't feel a sense of connectedness to their community, to a cause, or a close connection to other people, but volunteering can definitely promote that [connection]… It expands your social circle."

"It's really good to get outside and be connected to the community," said junior Celeste Miner. "[If] I find that if I'm feeling down or something, [volunteering] really helps me boost my energy." Miner regularly volunteers at the Giving Garden, a community garden in North Andover that donates what it grows to local food pantries. The Garden teaches kids about gardening, the outdoors, and hunger relief, and it operates with the help of hundreds of volunteers.

There are many ways to volunteer, and there's something for everyone. "A lot of volunteers have fun with it," said Emily

VOLUNTEERING / **page 4**



COURTESY PHOTO / **Emily Strong**

Celeste Miner holds freshly-picked onions at the Giving Garden.

EDITORIAL

CollegeBoard Scores 1 Out of 5 on AP Testing Administration

"Once you enter the start code, you may begin." With these words, hundreds of AP Psychology students at AHS expected to start their AP exam. Instead, they were greeted by a laggy, glitchy BlueBook testing app that refused to cooperate. For the students who were unable to coax the app into functioning, the exam was delayed to May 21—a poor solution for students who spent a whole year preparing for that moment.

We at ANDOVERVIEW believe that the fragile testing infrastructure of CollegeBoard is absolutely unacceptable. One would assume that a nonprofit organization that claims to be "paving the path for college success" would ensure that its testing platform relies upon servers that are able to handle the increased traffic on testing day. CollegeBoard provided very little consolation to the adrenaline-crashing students. "Most students have had a successful testing experience, with more than 5 million exams being successfully submitted thus far," the organization defended. The statement was tellingly short—PR representatives at CollegeBoard couldn't be bothered to devote any longer than a five-minute coffee break to drafting this "apology."

Unfortunately, technical glitches are not the only issues that CollegeBoard has encountered this AP season. After a slew of hate comments were slung in author Namwali Serpell's direction, she discovered that the vitriol was directed towards one particular passage in one of her books. The infamous "Look at Me" passage was recognized by this year's AP Lang students as an indecipherable jumble of content followed by some seriously difficult multiple-choice questions (MCQs). After learning this, Serpell revealed that CollegeBoard had included the passage in the test without her permission and distorted its meaning in the MCQs that followed. Adding insult to injury, Serpell also clearly stated that she was against standardized testing as a concept. As of late May, CollegeBoard had yet to address these comments.

The negligence of CollegeBoard has created a sorrowful state of affairs for those looking to take advantage of the benefits of AP courses and exams. To no one's surprise, the corporatization of education has introduced far more harm than benefit to all involved. We can only hope that CollegeBoard will hear and address some students' criticisms.

ANDOVERVIEW

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ANDOVERVIEW is a publication written, edited and designed by the Newspaper Production class to serve as an open forum for students to discuss issues relevant to the Andover High School community. Letters to the editor and guest commentaries are encouraged; please email submissions to:

andoverview@andoverma.us

Include contact information for verification purposes. The staff of ANDOVERVIEW reviews letters to the editor and guest commentaries and reserves the right to refuse material for reasons pertaining to length, clarity, libel, obscenity, copyright infringement, or material disruption to the educational process of Andover High School.

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ILLUSTRATION / **Brandon Nguyen**

FAREWELL COLUMNS

The Things I Wish I Drew

By Brandon Nguyen
EXECUTIVE EDITOR

There are a lot of things I managed to draw in high school: hands, birds, precariously stacked vases, the back of heads during math class. But there are just as many things I wished to capture, but never got around to, or never could. The moments that moved too fast, the ones too soft to sketch. The ones too strange or specific to explain to anyone who wasn't there.

So, as I get ready to close this chapter, this is my final portfolio: A collection of the things I wish I drew.

A quiet drive home after a long day. People crowded into the back seats, dozing off. A windy road stretches before us. Oil on canvas.

If I could, I would draw every moment between us, my closest friends. Spontaneous trips to the beach, late night study sessions on squeaky whiteboards. But the moments I hold closest are the quiet ones in between everything, the ones where all we needed to do was appreciate each other's company.

Thank you for weathering my chaos with love. Thank you for trusting me behind the wheel despite my questionable sense of direction, dramatic braking, and complete inability to parallel park. Thank you for answering my 3 AM texts, for making sleepless nights more bearable. Thank you for seeing through the sarcasm to the part of me that deeply cares, for staying. For the laughter, the unfiltered rants, the silence we shared without needing to fill it. You've held me up more than you know.

Just know: wherever you go, I'll always be happy to drive you there.

A classroom desk. On it, a pile of notes, pens and pencils strewn about. A pile of crumpled paper. Loose, expressive; charcoal on paper.

To my mentors, thank you for recognizing the dedication I put into your classes, and letting creativity thrive. For giving me a place where that dedication was not a force or burden, but instead a result of passion, nurtured by your teaching.

Thank you even more for giving me room to stretch and stumble. I wish I could draw the exact moment I realized I didn't have to be perfect to be worth listening to. That happened slowly, over a thousand kind gestures from teachers who believed in me, even when I didn't. Thank you for answering my email with way too many exclamation points, for reminding me that growth is messy and learning is nonlinear. You made the tough parts softer, and the curious parts brighter. Thank you for helping to keep my wonder, passions, and love of learning alive through the grindstone of the last four years.

Four friends crowd around a table. Burritos stuffed to the brim, laughter drawn in bold, colorful lines. Watercolor on paper.

To my fellow Execs, what a marvelous three years it's been. From 10-hour-long editing sessions to the after-class outings to McDonalds, Chipotle, or Mexica, we've built something far greater than a publication; we've built a home. We've swapped headlines, drama, layout templates and late-night life advice. From running around downtown getting street interviews to standing in the lobby shoving copies of the newspaper in people's faces, it's weird to think we might not have ever known each other without this production.

Thank you for the memories, the fast food, the unwavering support. I wouldn't have wanted to write this chapter of my life with anyone else.

Self-portrait, freshman me. Sleeping soundly in bed. Acrylic on canvas.

Sometimes I feel I don't draw myself enough. So here's a thank you to myself, older me to younger me. Thank you for pushing through when it felt like the world was collapsing. Thank you for being open to trying new things, thank you for having enough courage to take risks even when the outcome was uncertain. You didn't always know where you were going, but you kept moving forward with quiet strength.

Because of you, I've been able to become someone I'm proud of. I'm proud of us, and I am grateful for the choices you made. Get some sleep, you deserve it.

There are still things I wish I drew: the exact shade of blue the sky turned after our last club meeting, the weirdly comforting glow of the InDesign page at 1 AM, the inside joke no one remembers the origin of but still makes us laugh like we did the first time. I wish I could've captured the look on someone's face when they saw their story in print for the first time, or the moment we all sat back, looked at the finished paper, and thought, huh… that actually turned out okay.

High school wasn't always easy. Sometimes it was graphite smudges and broken pencils and running out of time. But it was also laughter that echoed off whiteboard walls, burrito-fueled brainstorms, and friends who showed up with snacks, playlists, and patience. To next year's staff, take things slow, and savor every moment. Thank you all for using your incredible writing and outstanding talent to keep building this little home we've made.

If the last four years were a sketchbook, mine is full now. Full of memories I didn't always know I was making, and people I'll never forget. And while this chapter is over, the next page is waiting.

I don't know what I'll draw next. But I know I'll bring everything and everyone from this portfolio with me.

Thanks for being part of the picture.

To You Guys

By Carissa Dessin
EXECUTIVE EDITOR

I have sat in my chair for hours, trying to think of ways to write this—to give it some sort of metaphor or moral—but I keep coming up empty. The Newspaper Production program has done so much for me that I wanted to do it justice in this farewell. Despite this, I've struggled to say goodbye, and now I finally understand why: I can never truly say goodbye.

From the hours spent in room 224—writing, editing, brainstorming—to the field trips, interviews, and unforgettable experiences, this program has shaped me in ways I never expected. It helped me discover my aspirations, pushed me to take risks, and revealed a side of myself I wouldn't have found otherwise. That's why I just can't say goodbye—because deep down, this program, these stories, and these moments will always be a part of me.

And if I can't say goodbye to the room, the stories, or the memories, I definitely can't say goodbye to the people. That's what makes this class special. That's what makes journalism—the people.

But, regrettably, my NewsProd successors I say goodbye to each and every one of you, not before I address you all personally:

Diya – Keep putting your voice out there. Your writing is strong, and your reporting is just as sharp. I say goodbye to your deadpan jokes that always leave me guessing.

Christina – I was shocked to learn, just 20 seconds ago, that you're a freshman. Your writing is elite, and your commitment to every story is unmatched. I say goodbye to your love for plain vanilla ice cream.

Janaesa – Your talent, humor, and brilliance shine through your writing. I say goodbye to you always "coincidentally" ending up paired with Ariana.

Clara – You have a passion for this class that few do. Keep pushing yourself to get the best, most in-depth stories. I say goodbye to your insightful questions.

Samantha – One of the most creative minds I've ever met. I say goodbye to your fire outfits.

Maddox – Is there anything you can't do? Writing, drawing, reporting—you turn any story into something special. I say goodbye to your peaceful energy.

Isabella – I have no doubt you'll excel as an editor next year. You have the talent, the passion, and the drive. I say goodbye to your underrated humor.

Saarvi – You are funny, smart, and a bright light in this class. Seeing your growth from freshman year has been incredible. I say goodbye to you liking all of my Instagram stories.

Abby – Your persistence and passion for this class inspire me. I say goodbye to you cornering me with NewsProd questions as soon as I walked into Psych.

Arshiaa – Your writing and ideas are some of the best I've seen. Keep creating—you have serious talent. I say goodbye to you and the swim girls coming late to class in the fall.

Shreya – You bring your perspective into every conversation, and your knack for interviewing elevates the paper. I say goodbye to you talking about MUN or GMI—or any of the 101 clubs you're part of.

Ariana – Your talent is undeniable, whether in writing, presenting, or reporting. I say goodbye to how you're always on the winning team for news quizzes.

Areeta – Cool, funny, and an outstanding writer and reporter. I say goodbye to the nonchalant scale.

Avery – One of the most driven freshmen I've ever met. Keep chasing the greatest stories. I say goodbye to your endless debates—go Gators.

Tommy – Your writing, whether editorial or satire, is a joy to read. I say goodbye to you making me have opinions I didn't know I had.

Anushka – Your calming presence and passion make this class better. I say goodbye to your very lengthy opinions that I had to edit.

Ella – You are a distinct force in journalism. Your maturity in interviewing and information-gathering is impressive. I say goodbye to you cornering me every class.

Kaveri & Anya – Sorry, but there's no way to address you separately. You're some of the most insane and incoherent people I've ever met, but I would be lying if I said I wouldn't miss it. Keep writing together. I say goodbye to your incessant voice notes.

My fellow Executive Editors – I have never shared more laughs—or frustration—with another group. I'll miss our countless hours at Café Nero, Mexica, or wherever we ended up. I say goodbye to Brandon's inability to realize how talented he is, Eva's passion for grammar, and Harry's questionable stomach issues (sorry). Most of all, I say goodbye to our near-death experiences in Brandon's car.

Mr. Aubrey – You have played an enormous role in shaping who I am today. Thank you for instilling passion in me and encouraging me to grow. I wish you the best next year—it only goes up from here. I say goodbye to you thinking I'm always rolling my eyes.

Every one of you is crucial to this program. You make the difference in each other's lives and your own. As I leave you with these words, I hope you continue to grow and create stories that matter. Whether you're a freshman, sophomore, or junior, this is not the end. It's just the beginning.

Love you all,
Reese's out.

A Word of Advice

By Eva Liss
EXECUTIVE EDITOR

If I have one piece of advice to give you all—and if you read this paper front to back, this doesn't apply to you, as I know you do it already—it is to pick something, and stick to it.

But first, I'm going to tell you a little story of persistence.

I joined Newspaper when I was 14. I didn't know anyone, thanks to remote eighth grade, and I definitely didn't know what anyone looked like below their eyes, thanks to masks. It was sort of lonely, but stepping into the library for my first ANDOVERVIEW meeting, I thought: maybe this'll be the thing that sticks.

My optimism was astounding. Unlearning my writing style—learning to write with no voice at all—took nearly the whole year. On top of that, there've been countless times in my life where I've been swamped with work and remembered, suddenly and rather inconveniently: I have an article to write, including when I had COVID during freshman year, during Thanksgiving, during show week for RENT (and a teacher strike), the first week of senior year, and even now. ANDOVERVIEW stuck all right, but it took monumental effort.

In this way, ANDOVERVIEW has been a true throughline for me. Every Monday morning, I'd dread the week, until I remembered Newspaper met that night. I grew to look forward to the weekly Schoology agendas, the four-week schedule that we could never keep to, and a Google Drive full of unedited articles. I found myself planning the snacks I'd bring to writing sessions as soon as the last one was over. I kept showing up. Not out of obligation, but because I found myself caring—maybe too much. I cared about the commas, the coverage, the tone of a single headline. And even when it felt overwhelming, I never wanted to be anywhere else.

It's not necessary for you to know all the times I found it inconvenient, or downright bothersome, to have to deal with something for ANDOVERVIEW. I assure you, there were many. I don't think you can love something as thoroughly as I love the paper without also being hyper-aware of its flaws.

Yet those flaws were part of the reason I stayed at ANDOVERVIEW. The barely-organized chaos was what made it entertaining, and all of you readers who are planning on throwing this paper in the recycling when you're done—you are what made it enticing. No matter how much I struggled doing it, I knew I could change ANDOVERVIEW.

I hadn't known—could never have imagined—the way Newspaper would seed itself into every aspect of my life when I chose it on Aspen one unassuming March day in eighth grade. As we've grown up together, though, ANDOVERVIEW has helped me realize how close I really wanted to be to you all: how much I loved the whimsy every underclassman brought with them to news quizzes, how much I relied on my co-editors to pull me through hard days, how much I looked forward to helping them all talk through their hopes and fears for next year or getting $5 Mexica burritos when we should have been studying or editing college supplementals. That's what I mean by picking something and sticking to it: I gave parts of myself to you, my friends, and continuously, I was given parts in return.

Stick with it. Pull yourself up, and once you're up there, or even as you're climbing, pull others up with you. As my time at ANDOVERVIEW taught me, that's what makes a leader: a steady voice and presence, a bravery to say here's what you're doing wrong, and kindness as a guiding principle. I'm not saying be sickly sweet. Be as dry and nonchalant as you want—but make sure the people you care about know you care. You owe it to them, and you owe it to yourself, to make something of the things you start. It'll pay off. I promise.

How Newspaper Changed My Course

By Harry Guo
EXECUTIVE EDITOR

If you had asked me four years ago what I would be majoring in for college, I would've said computer science without a second thought. Writing was just something I did for fun, but then came the newspaper and four years later, here I am, declaring "Literary Arts" as my major.

It was almost like fate when I found out that the advisor for the newspaper was my H1 teacher. Even more fateful when the opinion column that was supposed to go in my spot never came through, leaving room for mine. I remember feeling pretty fraudulent back then: a freshman with no journalism experience who suddenly had a byline in the newspaper. But something clicked when I saw my name in print for the first time.

In my first year on staff, I paired up with my friend and fellow first-year staff writer Brandon Nguyen. We covered just about everything together—from complicated stories like the school building project, where we sat on a Zoom call with all the architects while I was running a 103-degree fever, to the simpler but no less unforgettable ones, like the pig dissections, where, a year later, we had to go back and delete a paragraph from that story featuring a dropout and former student who supported the practice, a quote that ended up angering some of his Middle Eastern investors and losing him money. Even in senior year, we still find ourselves dabbling in new topics, heading to football and basketball games, and quickly learning that flash photography during sports probably wasn't the best idea.

And there were also the unforgettable stories of the Andover Education Association teacher strike. The yelling matches during the usually dull committee meetings, our middle school history teacher getting escorted out by police, and the days spent walking around with our mini microphones interviewing elementary schoolers about their thoughts on the strikes. We also made Instagram reels that captured the chaos as we somehow survived Brandon's driving, rushing from one event to the next.

And it's because of these moments that what I'll remember most isn't about the content of the articles we wrote. It's the times we bonded over hot pot dinners with Mr. Aubrey; got scarred by the stank of the Fortnite room; when I accidentally climbed into a stranger's car, scaring some poor old man half to death because I suffer from "car blindness"; getting side-eyed by Vismay because my stomach couldn't handle the wrath of two McChickens; outmaneuvering and successfully avoiding my senior assassin on the T; the time in Boston where I ordered Chipotle online, asked for light sour cream, but got sour cream soup instead; and finally having the chance to meet the man, the myth, the legend: Harry Proudfoot.

And now, my eyesight is probably 20/200 from squinting at InDesign layouts for hours on end. But even through the eye strain, I would never trade it for anything. Of course, there are perks to being on the newspaper. Your teachers start thinking you're smarter than you actually are. You get to see your name in print. And to be frank… it looks great on college applications. But as much as my ego was boosted by bylines and front-page headline stories, it was also humbled.

Because for every story that I got to write, there was a group of the brightest people in AHS in room 224 whose sheer intelligence never ceased to amaze (and slightly intimidate) me. Whether it's Tommy's consistent sassy editorials and cheeky satires, Avery's perseverance to take on the entire back page of Issue 5, or Anya's ability to find a creative angle to tackle the overdone topic of AI, every person on this newspaper brings their own unique strengths that when put together, create something incredibly in-depth and engaging.

So, my advice for underclassmen? Do what you actually enjoy. Take things slow. You don't have to have it all figured out by the end of high school. Who knows what will happen? You might start high school convinced you're going to code the next great app and end up writing your way into college instead.

AND OVER VIEW

Celebrating New Beginnings

GRADUATION / **from page 1**

as these students were starting as freshmen, shared that this was the first group of graduates she served fully during their four years.

In his uplifting speech, Principal Jimmy D'Andrea expressed a deep appreciation for the first class of seniors he oversaw at AHS. He urged graduates to express gratitude for their support systems while inspiring reflection and encouragement for the future.

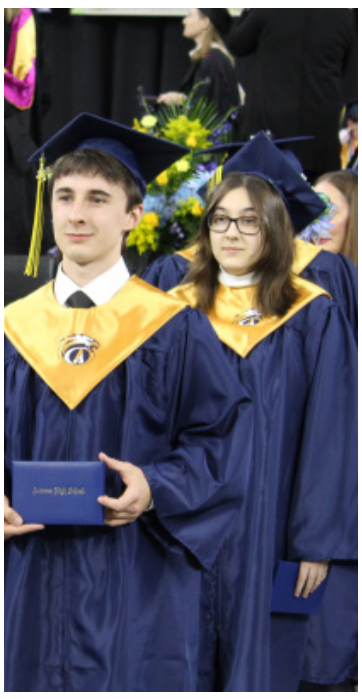
"You are awesome individuals who have achieved tremendous success," he said.

After winning the hearts of AHS students in just one year with his kind gestures and presence at every school-related event, it was only a surprise to D'Andrea himself that he was awarded the 2025 Distinguished Citizen Award. In fact, the ceremony began with a reference to his recognizable Sunday night calls, prompting the audience's first chuckle of the evening.

"He demonstrated the impact that one person can have when they truly care," said senior Carissa Dessin as she recognized the principal's efforts in her speech announcing the recipient of the Distinguished Citizen Award.

The heartfelt ceremony emphasized the group's strength as a community and a bright future beyond AHS for every student. These bittersweet moments left graduates with the initiative to embrace change, face the future with confidence, and carry forward the determination that has shaped them.

Reminiscing about the pandemic, Dever remarked, "I understand that there are varying degrees of outgoingness among us, but I do believe that if we can get to know each other as awkward 14-year-olds with our faces covered, we can get to know anyone in the world."



STAFF PHOTOS / **Anya Gorovits & Kaveri Dole**

Boulevard Banners for Senior Class Gift

COURTESY PHOTO / **Alicia Linsey**
A mockup of the banners the Class of 2025 will be gifting to AHS.

By Christina Saad || STAFF WRITER

The Class of 2025 chose AHS boulevard banners that will adorn light poles along the front driveway to the school as their graduation gift.

The banners will be installed within the next few months, most likely during the summer. The gift was decided on by the senior board, which proposed ideas for a class gift, and the graduation committee, who the board collaborated with to make a final decision.

The graduation committee wanted a gift that adequately encapsulates the drive, hard work, passion, and enthusiasm of their class. They agreed on light pole banners to create a welcoming atmosphere for students and families arriving at the school, and to be a lasting reminder of the graduating class's contribution.

"It's a public, year-round way to leave a legacy," said Assistant Principal Alicia Linsey.

The decision was made in the past two months through discussions with the graduation committee. Five design options for the banner were presented, and the seniors voted on their favorite design during the graduation rehearsal meeting on May 23.

"The graduation committee chose something to inspire future graduating classes and community members to lead and act with spirit and authenticity," said senior Shreya Desai, who announced the gift at the graduation ceremony.

Past senior gifts have included outside tables for the cafeteria, benches in the foyer, and chairs and tables for the nook on the third floor.

Grads Weigh In on Past, Future

WHAT WAS YOUR FONDEST MEMORY IN HIGH SCHOOL?

Natalie Cordio: "Spending time with my friends and watching us all grow together throughout four years."

Sophia Ciaccio: "Probably just growing up with my friends and meeting my closest friends in high school. I feel like it's been such a learning curve, and I've really grown as a person."

Aidan Loucks: "I guess cross country first season freshman year was my favorite. I met so many new friends and it was just like such a new time in my life, and it was really cool to experience new things."

Sharayu Josh: "I think definitely math classes with my Friday group. It was very entertaining, but also we got to learn a lot."

Grace Lilley: "I would say I really liked the senior semi and going with all my friends."

Daniel Shin: "My fondest memory in high school. Probably, like planning the pep rally for student government. "

WHAT ARE YOU MOST EXCITED ABOUT IN THE FUTURE?

Madison Hamilton: "In college, I'm double majoring in fine arts and entrepreneurship, and I'm kind of excited to see where that goes. It's really exciting."

Sharayu Josh: "Definitely expanding my hobbies and seeing what else I can do in college. I'll have a lot more free time to figure out my own schedule, so that makes it for that."

Judy Elketory: "I'm so excited to meet new people and gain knowledge ... that other people have that they can pass on to me."

Charlie Howard: "Just my future—of course to be able to do whatever I feel like I want to do. Hopefully to be successful, but, yeah, just life."

Youssef Gdihi: "I'm excited to ditch these people. I also am excited to be rich and young."

Reporting by Ariana Teasdale & Janessa Macasaet

Volunteering Can Help Students Build Hope, Self-Confidence

VOLUNTEERING / **from page 1**

Strong, the Farm Manager at the Giving Garden. "Some find it very therapeutic to be out in the sunshine [doing] repetitive tasks… You can just get lost in your own thoughts or in conversation while you're doing the work. It's a really nice change of pace from modern life. Other people… come out with a group of friends so that it's just something that they can all do together."

Freshman Mo Gearin has enjoyed many of these benefits during his five years volunteering for Eco Team, a program run by the Andover Village Improvement Society (AVIS). Eco Team focuses on removing invasive plants and promoting native ones on Andover's trails. "The people there are great… they're all fun to talk to," Gearin said about Eco Team. "I like learning about… the plants and how they impact the biodiversity, and other interesting environmental factors of different forests... There's also muffins. Amy makes amazing muffins."

For young people who are disappointed by the current political climate, volunteering can be an effective way to boost self-confidence, hope, and tenacity. As Strong put it, "for young people in particular, coming and volunteering at the Garden and growing food for your neighbors is [a] great way to feel the sense of self-efficacy. [That's] the sense of 'I can make a difference.' For young people who can't vote, and may feel like they don't have a voice on what's going on in the world… this is a way that they can have a positive impact and make a very tangible difference in the world."

People may think of volunteering as unpaid manual labor, but in fact, there are many ways to volunteer that require very different skill sets. It doesn't even have to be in-person or a regular time-commitment. According to Desfosse,"There's plenty of things anybody can do behind the scenes… even if they feel like they're maxed out in their schedule, [like setting] up a Sign-Up Genius or [making a] flyer."

Furthermore, the benefits of volunteering extend into adulthood. According to another study by Jinho Kim and Kerem Morgül at the University of Wisconsin-Madison, volunteering as a teen is linked with higher earnings, more schooling, and better well-being as an adult. This could be because it benefits college applications, but it is likely also because while volunteering, you're developing valuable skills and qualities that will be used a lot later in life.

If a student is interested in volunteering somewhere, Strong recommended starting with many places and narrowing it down as you go. "If you get a few volunteer hours while helping out at different places… that's really good because you get to explore more things… On the other hand, the more often you volunteer somewhere, the more skilled you become. I have volunteers who come regularly, and I don't need to go teach them anymore… and [they] can feel good because [they] don't need to be babysat… That's a neat experience for kids who have the time to come regularly."